

Manel Leiva

Senior Design Systems Designer

SUMMARY

Senior Design Systems Designer with two production systems built from scratch at Abacum and Remuner. Both covered the same: Token Studio and Figma variables for token authoring, Style Dictionary for multi-target export, npm packages, Storybook for documentation, and Chromatic for visual regression. At Abacum I defined the token architecture and cross-squad governance that kept Figma aligned with production as the product scaled. At Remuner I built the entire pipeline as the sole designer. Engineers pulled updates in both cases without needing to involve design. Relevant case: <https://www.manel-leiva.com/cases/design-systems>

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer

Remuner

May 2024 - Mar 2026 · Barcelona, hybrid

Built the design system as the sole designer. Token Studio and Figma variables for token authoring, Style Dictionary for multi-target export, npm package for engineering consumption. Storybook for component documentation, Chromatic for visual regression. Engineers pulled updates without involving design.

Set up and maintained a separate icons repository developers could pull on their own.

Started with a deliberately small token set (lesson learned from Abacum). A minimal set is easier to govern and easier to scale than a comprehensive one that never gets adopted.

Established the design discipline from scratch: processes, rituals, and documentation the cross-functional team could actually use.

Senior Product Designer

Abacum

Jan 2022 - Apr 2024 · Barcelona, hybrid

Led design system standardisation across squads. Defined the token architecture and component library structure, then built the governance that kept Figma aligned with production through multiple releases.

Built the full engineering pipeline with a dedicated engineer: Token Studio and Style Dictionary for token export, a GitHub submodule connected to an npm package, ESLint rules for adoption enforcement, Storybook in Chromatic for component documentation and visual regression.

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Skills

Design Systems: Token Studio, Style Dictionary, Storybook, Chromatic, MUI, npm, ESLint, GitHub

Design: Figma, component architecture, token architecture, documentation, design critique

Process: cross-squad governance, DS adoption strategies, engineering handoff, JIRA

Domain: fintech, FP&A, B2B SaaS

Languages

Spanish (native)

Catalan (native)

English (professional)

Kept MUI as the base component library rather than building from scratch. That tradeoff let us move faster and focus effort on the token layer and governance instead of low-level component work.

Presented the DS business case to engineering leadership alongside the Head of Design. Launched Maker Days to drive adoption across squads.

Senior UX Designer & Co-founder

Kings of Mambo

Sep 2010 - Nov 2021 · Barcelona, hybrid

Co-founded and ran a UX studio for over a decade. Took on the studio's most complex projects: KYMCO Spain's backoffice, vLex Iceberg (a legal document repository), e-commerce builds, and custom WordPress development. Most projects meant learning an unfamiliar domain fast and working close enough to code to know what I was asking developers to build.

EDUCATION

Higher National Diploma in Computing Design and Multimedia

ESI (Escuela de Sistemas Informáticos)

2002